

# Word family: reduce / reduces / reduced / reducing / reduction / reductions / reductive / reducible / irreducible / reducer / reductionism / reductionist

**Base word:** reduce

**Part of speech:** mainly verb

**Related forms:**

- **reduce** (v.) — 減少;降低;縮小;使變弱;使陷入某狀態;化簡;濃縮
- **reduced** (adj./participle) — 減少了的;降低了的;折扣的;簡化了的
- **reduction** (n.) — 減少;降低;縮減;折扣;化簡;還原
- **reductive** (adj.) — 過分簡化的;把複雜事情簡化得失真的
- **reducible** (adj.) — 可減少的;可化簡的;可還原的
- **irreducible** (adj.) — 不能再減少/化簡的;不可約的;最基本的
- **reducer** (n.) — 減速器;變徑接頭;減壓/減量裝置等, 視領域而定
- **reductionism** (n.) — 還原論
- **reductionist** (adj./n.) — 還原論的;還原論者

**Major useful extensions:**

reduce confusion, reduce risk, reduce costs, reduce spending, reduce waste, reduce stress, reduce pressure, reduce pollution, reduce emissions, reduce inequality, reduce unemployment, reduce demand, reduce supply, reduce prices, reduce the number/amount/level/rate, reduce by, reduce to, reduce from A to B, reduce something significantly/substantially, reduce something to zero, reduce something to half, reduced price, reduced rate, reduced fare, reduced hours, reduced circumstances, reduce someone to tears, reduce someone to silence, reduce someone to doing something, reduce something to rubble/ashes, reduce a problem to its essentials, reduce something to a formula, reduce a fraction, reduce an equation, reduce to lowest terms, reduce a sauce, reduce liquid, reduction in, reduction of, cost reduction, risk reduction, waste reduction, emissions reduction, reduction target, reduction rate, reduction gear, chemical reduction, oxidation-reduction/redox, data reduction, dimensionality reduction, noise reduction, breast reduction, fracture reduction, reductionism, reductive explanation.

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# Meaning in this passage

Brief but regular meetings, written summaries and digital project-management tools can **reduce confusion substantially**.

Here, **reduce** means:

**to make the amount, degree, or intensity of something smaller or lower — 減少; 降低; 減輕**

The writer means that structured communication can make confusion **much less severe or widespread**.

中文翻譯：

簡短但定期的會議、書面摘要和數碼項目管理工具，都可以大幅減少混亂。

So here:

**reduce confusion** = 令混亂的程度下降，使大家更清楚自己要做甚麼

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## A. GENERAL DECREASE

### 1. reduce something — 減少; 降低

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

#### Practice 1 — original sentence

These tools can **reduce confusion substantially**.

這些工具可以大幅減少混亂。

#### Practice 2

Clear instructions can **reduce mistakes**.

清晰指示可以減少錯誤。

### Practice 3

Better planning may **reduce delays**.

更好的規劃可以減少延誤。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce** = 令某物的數量、程度、規模或強度變小

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## 2. reduce the amount of something — 減少某物的數量

### Practice 1

The company wants to **reduce the amount of waste** it produces.

公司希望減少產生的廢物量。

### Practice 2

Better coordination reduces the amount of duplicated work.

更好的協調可以減少重複工作的數量。

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## 3. reduce the number of something — 減少數目

### Practice 1

The new system **reduced the number of errors**.

新系統減少了錯誤數目。

### Practice 2

Automation may reduce the number of repetitive tasks.

自動化可能減少重複性任務的數量。

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## 4. reduce the level of something — 降低水平／程度

### Practice 1

The changes reduced the **level of uncertainty**.

這些改變降低了不確定程度。

### Practice 2

Exercise can reduce stress levels.

運動可以降低壓力水平。

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## 5. reduce the rate of something — 降低比率／速度

### Practice 1

The programme aims to **reduce the error rate**.

計劃旨在降低錯誤率。

### Practice 2

Safety measures reduced the accident rate.

安全措施降低了事故率。

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## 6. reduce the size of something — 縮小

### Practice 1

The company decided to **reduce the size of the team**.

公司決定縮小團隊規模。

### Practice 2

Compressing the file reduces its size.

壓縮檔案會縮小檔案大小。

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## 7. reduce the length/duration — 縮短

### Practice 1

The new process **reduced waiting times**.

新流程縮短了等候時間。

### Practice 2

The manager reduced the meeting from an hour to thirty minutes.

經理把會議由一小時縮短至三十分鐘。

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## B. DEGREE / INTENSITY

## 8. reduce confusion — 減少混亂

### Practice 1

Clear roles **reduce confusion**.

清晰角色可以減少混亂。

## Practice 2

Written summaries help reduce confusion after meetings.

書面摘要有助減少會議後的混亂。

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# 9. reduce stress — 減輕壓力

## Practice 1

Better workload planning can **reduce stress**.

更好的工作量規劃可以減輕壓力。

## Practice 2

Regular breaks may reduce stress.

定期休息可能有助降低壓力。

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# 10. reduce pressure — 減輕壓力; 降低壓力

## Practice 1

Hiring more staff could **reduce pressure on the team**.

增聘員工可以減輕團隊壓力。

## Practice 2

The valve reduces water pressure.

這個閥門可以降低水壓。

Same English phrase, but Chinese changes with context:

- psychological → 減輕壓力
  - physical → 降低壓力
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## 11. reduce pain — 減輕疼痛

### Practice 1

The treatment may **reduce pain**.

治療可能減輕疼痛。

### Practice 2

Ice can help reduce swelling and pain.

冰敷可以幫助減輕腫脹和疼痛。

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## 12. reduce tension — 緩和緊張

### Practice 1

Better communication can **reduce tension between departments**.

更好的溝通可以緩和部門之間的緊張關係。

### Practice 2

The meeting helped reduce tension.

會議有助降低緊張氣氛。

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## 13. reduce uncertainty — 減少不確定性

### Practice 1

Clear deadlines **reduce uncertainty**.

清楚的截止日期可以減少不確定性。

## Practice 2

More information may reduce uncertainty.

更多資料可能降低不確定程度。

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# 14. reduce anxiety — 減輕焦慮

## Practice 1

Clear expectations can **reduce anxiety**.

清晰期望可以減輕焦慮。

## Practice 2

Preparation may reduce anxiety before an interview.

充分準備可能有助減輕面試前焦慮。

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# C. RISK / HARM

# 15. reduce risk — 降低風險

## Practice 1

Compliance checks help **reduce risk**.

合規檢查有助降低風險。

## Practice 2

Diversification may reduce investment risk.

分散投資可能降低投資風險。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce risk** = 令不良結果發生的可能性或影響程度降低

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## 16. reduce the risk of something — 降低某事風險

### Practice 1

Clear communication can **reduce the risk of mistakes**.

清晰溝通可以降低犯錯風險。

### Practice 2

Backups reduce the risk of data loss.

備份可以降低數據遺失的風險。

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## 17. risk reduction — 風險降低; 減低風險

### Practice 1

Training is an important part of **risk reduction**.

培訓是降低風險的重要部分。

### Practice 2

The project includes several risk-reduction measures.

項目包含數項風險降低措施。

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## 18. harm reduction — 減害

An established public-health/social-policy term.

### Practice 1

The programme follows a **harm-reduction approach**.

該計劃採取減害方式。

### Practice 2

Harm reduction focuses on reducing negative consequences.

減害著重降低不良後果。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**harm reduction** = 不一定完全消除某行為，而先降低其造成的傷害和風險

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## D. COST / MONEY

## 19. reduce costs — 降低成本

### Practice 1

Automation can **reduce costs**.

自動化可以降低成本。

### Practice 2

The company reduced operating costs.

公司降低了營運成本。

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## 20. reduce spending/expenditure — 減少開支

### Practice 1

Management plans to **reduce spending**.

管理層計劃減少開支。

### Practice 2

The department was asked to reduce expenditure.

該部門被要求削減支出。

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## 21. reduce a budget — 削減預算

### Practice 1

The budget was **reduced by ten percent**.

預算被削減百分之十。

### Practice 2

Management reduced the department's budget.

管理層削減了部門預算。

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## 22. reduce debt — 減少債務

### Practice 1

The company used profits to **reduce debt**.

公司用盈利減少債務。

## Practice 2

Households may cut spending to reduce debt.

家庭可能削減開支以減債。

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# 23. cost reduction — 成本削減

## Practice 1

The company launched a **cost-reduction programme**.

公司推出一項成本削減計劃。

## Practice 2

Cost reduction should not damage quality.

降低成本不應損害質素。

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# E. PRICE / RATE / PAYMENT

## 24. reduce a price — 降價

### Practice 1

The shop **reduced the price** by 20%.

商店把價格降低了百分之二十。

### Practice 2

Prices were reduced after demand weakened.

需求轉弱後，價格被下調。

---

## 25. reduced price — 減價; 優惠價

### Practice 1

The item is available at a **reduced price**.

該商品現以減價／優惠價出售。

### Practice 2

Students can buy tickets at reduced prices.

學生可以優惠價購票。

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## 26. reduced rate — 優惠／較低費率

### Practice 1

Children pay a **reduced rate**.

兒童支付較低費率。

### Practice 2

Members receive a reduced rate.

會員可享優惠收費。

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## 27. reduced fare — 優惠車費／票價

### Practice 1

Seniors may qualify for a **reduced fare**.

長者可能符合資格享用優惠票價。

### Practice 2

Students travel at reduced fares.

學生可享優惠車費。

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## 28. reduce interest rates — 降低利率

### Practice 1

The bank decided to **reduce interest rates**.

銀行決定降低利率。

### Practice 2

Lower rates may reduce borrowing costs.

較低利率可能降低借貸成本。

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## F. QUANTITY / SUPPLY / DEMAND

## 29. reduce demand — 降低需求

### Practice 1

Higher prices may **reduce demand**.

較高價格可能降低需求。

### Practice 2

Remote work reduced demand for office space.

遙距工作降低了辦公空間需求。

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## 30. reduce supply — 減少供應

### Practice 1

Bad weather **reduced supply**.

惡劣天氣減少供應。

### Practice 2

Production cuts reduced the supply of the product.

減產令產品供應量下降。

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## 31. reduce consumption — 減少消耗／消費

### Practice 1

The company wants to **reduce energy consumption**.

公司希望減少能源消耗。

### Practice 2

Higher prices may reduce consumption.

價格上升可能減少消費。

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## 32. reduce usage/use — 減少使用

### Practice 1

Offices are trying to **reduce paper use**.

辦公室正嘗試減少用紙。

## **Practice 2**

The policy reduced unnecessary system usage.

政策減少了不必要的系統使用。

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# **G. ENVIRONMENT**

## **33. reduce waste — 減少廢物**

### **Practice 1**

Reusable containers help **reduce waste**.

可重用容器有助減少廢物。

### **Practice 2**

The factory introduced measures to reduce production waste.

工廠推出措施減少生產廢料。

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## **34. waste reduction — 減廢**

### **Practice 1**

Waste reduction is part of the sustainability strategy.

減廢是可持續策略的一部分。

### **Practice 2**

The programme sets waste-reduction targets.

計劃設定了減廢目標。

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## 35. reduce pollution — 減少污染

### Practice 1

Public transport can help **reduce pollution**.

公共交通可以幫助減少污染。

### Practice 2

New rules aim to reduce air pollution.

新規例旨在減少空氣污染。

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## 36. reduce emissions — 減排 ; 減少排放

### Practice 1

The company aims to **reduce emissions**.

公司旨在減少排放。

### Practice 2

Cleaner technology can reduce carbon emissions.

較清潔的科技可以減少碳排放。

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## 37. emissions reduction — 減排

### Practice 1

The plan includes an **emissions-reduction target**.

計劃包括一項減排目標。

### Practice 2

Emissions reductions were larger than expected.

排放削減幅度高於預期。

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## 38. reduce your carbon footprint — 減少碳足跡

### Practice 1

Businesses are looking for ways to **reduce their carbon footprint**.

企業正尋找方法減少碳足跡。

### Practice 2

Using less energy can reduce your carbon footprint.

減少能源使用可以降低碳足跡。

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## H. WORKFORCE / SCALE

## 39. reduce staff / staffing levels — 減少人手

### Practice 1

The company plans to **reduce staffing levels**.

公司計劃減少人手。

## Practice 2

Several departments reduced staff numbers.

數個部門縮減員工人數。

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# 40. reduce the workforce — 裁減人手

## Practice 1

The company was forced to **reduce its workforce**.

公司被迫削減員工人數。

## Practice 2

Automation may reduce the size of the workforce.

自動化可能令員工規模縮小。

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# 41. reduce capacity — 降低產能／容量

## Practice 1

The factory **reduced production capacity**.

工廠降低了生產能力。

## Practice 2

Maintenance temporarily reduced system capacity.

維修暫時降低了系統容量。

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## 42. reduced hours — 縮短工時

### Practice 1

She returned to work on **reduced hours**.

她復工後採用縮短工時安排。

### Practice 2

The company introduced reduced working hours.

公司實施縮短工時。

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## I. SOCIAL / ECONOMIC PROBLEMS

## 43. reduce inequality — 減少不平等

### Practice 1

The programme aims to **reduce inequality**.

計劃旨在減少不平等。

### Practice 2

Better access to education may reduce inequality.

改善教育機會可能降低不平等程度。

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## 44. reduce poverty — 減少貧窮

### Practice 1

Economic growth alone may not **reduce poverty**.

單靠經濟增長未必能減少貧窮。

### Practice 2

The programme was introduced to reduce child poverty.

計劃旨在減少兒童貧窮問題。

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## 45. reduce unemployment — 降低失業率

### Practice 1

Investment may help **reduce unemployment**.

投資可能有助降低失業率。

### Practice 2

The policy aims to reduce youth unemployment.

政策旨在降低青年失業問題。

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## 46. reduce crime — 減少罪案

### Practice 1

Better lighting may help **reduce crime**.

更好的照明可能有助減少罪案。

### Practice 2

The programme aims to reduce violent crime.

計劃旨在減少暴力罪案。

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## J. HEALTH / MEDICAL LEVELS

### 47. reduce blood pressure — 降低血壓

#### Practice 1

Exercise can help **reduce blood pressure**.

運動可以幫助降低血壓。

#### Practice 2

The medicine reduced her blood pressure.

藥物降低了她的血壓。

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### 48. reduce cholesterol — 降低膽固醇

#### Practice 1

Dietary changes may help **reduce cholesterol levels**.

改變飲食可能有助降低膽固醇水平。

#### Practice 2

The treatment reduced LDL cholesterol.

治療降低了 **LDL** 膽固醇。

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## 49. reduce swelling/inflammation — 減輕腫脹／炎症

### Practice 1

Ice may **reduce swelling**.

冰敷可能減輕腫脹。

### Practice 2

The drug helps **reduce inflammation**.

這種藥物有助減少炎症。

---

## 50. reduce symptoms — 減輕症狀

### Practice 1

The treatment can **reduce symptoms**.

治療可以減輕症狀。

### Practice 2

Rest may **reduce the severity of symptoms**.

休息可能減輕症狀嚴重程度。

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## K. REDUCE BY / TO / FROM

## 51. reduce by + amount — 減少了.....

A critical grammar pattern.

## Practice 1

Costs were **reduced by 20%**.

成本減少了百分之二十。

## Practice 2

The meeting was reduced by fifteen minutes.

會議時間縮短了十五分鐘。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce by X** = 減少的幅度是 X

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# 52. reduce to + final level — 降至.....

## Practice 1

Costs were **reduced to \$1 million**.

成本降至一百萬元。

## Practice 2

The team was reduced to five members.

團隊人數減至五人。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce to X** = 最終降低至 X 這個水平／數量

---

# 53. reduce from A to B — 從 A 降至 B

## Practice 1

The error rate was **reduced from 10% to 4%**.

錯誤率由百分之十降至百分之四。

## Practice 2

The meeting was reduced from one hour to thirty minutes.

會議由一小時縮短至三十分鐘。

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# 54. reduce something by half — 減少一半

## Practice 1

The new process **reduced waiting time by half**.

新流程把等候時間減少了一半。

## Practice 2

The team wants to reduce errors by half.

團隊希望把錯誤減少一半。

---

# 55. reduce something to half — 減至原來一半

## Practice 1

Costs were **reduced to half their previous level**.

成本降至原來的一半。

## Practice 2

The workforce was reduced to half its original size.

員工人數減至原來一半。

---

## 56. reduce to zero — 減至零

### Practice 1

The aim is to **reduce avoidable errors to zero**.

目標是把可避免錯誤減至零。

### Practice 2

The balance was reduced to zero.

餘額降至零。

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## L. DEGREE ADVERBS

## 57. reduce substantially — 大幅減少

This is the exact collocation in your passage.

### Practice 1 — original sentence

Digital tools can **reduce confusion substantially**.

數碼工具可以大幅減少混亂。

### Practice 2

The new process substantially reduced delays.

新流程大幅減少了延誤。

---

## 58. reduce significantly — 顯著降低

## Practice 1

Training **significantly reduced errors**.

培訓顯著減少了錯誤。

## Practice 2

The risk was significantly reduced.

風險得到顯著降低。

---

# 59. reduce dramatically/sharply — 大幅／急劇降低

## Practice 1

Automation **dramatically reduced processing time**.

自動化大幅縮短了處理時間。

## Practice 2

Output was sharply reduced.

產量被大幅削減。

---

# 60. reduce slightly/marginally — 略微減少

## Practice 1

Costs were **slightly reduced**.

成本略有下降。

## Practice 2

The change only marginally reduced the risk.

這項改變只稍微降低了風險。

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## M. REDUCE SOMEONE/SOMETHING TO A STATE

### 61. reduce someone/something to something — 使陷入／變成某狀態

A genuinely different major branch.

#### Practice 1

The shock **reduced him to silence**.

震驚令他啞口無言。

#### Practice 2

Years of neglect reduced the building to a ruin.

多年缺乏保養令建築物變得破敗不堪。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce X to Y** = 令 X 失去原來狀態而變成較差、較基本或較極端的 Y

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### 62. reduce someone to tears — 令某人流淚

A very common idiom.

#### Practice 1

The criticism **reduced her to tears**.

那些批評令她哭了起來。

## Practice 2

He was reduced to tears by the news.

消息令他傷心得流淚。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce someone to tears** = 令某人情緒強烈到哭出來

---

# 63. reduce someone to silence — 令某人無言

## Practice 1

The question **reduced the room to silence**.

這個問題令全場陷入沉默。

## Practice 2

His reply reduced his critics to silence.

他的回答令批評者無話可說。

---

# 64. reduce someone to desperation — 使某人陷入絕望

## Practice 1

Years of debt **reduced the family to desperation**.

多年的債務令這個家庭陷入絕望。

## Practice 2

The situation had reduced him to desperation.

情況已令他走投無路。

---

## 65. reduce someone to begging — 使某人落到要乞求／乞討

### Practice 1

Poverty had **reduced him to begging**.

貧困令他淪落到要乞討。

### Practice 2

She refused to be reduced to asking for favours.

她不願淪落到要向人求情。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**be reduced to doing X** = 因處境變差而迫不得已只能做 X

---

## 66. be reduced to doing something — 淪落到／只能做某事

### Practice 1

Without clear evidence, they were **reduced to guessing**.

沒有清晰證據，他們只能靠猜。

### Practice 2

The team was reduced to working with outdated equipment.

團隊被迫只能使用過時設備工作。

This often implies an undesirable loss of options.

---

## N. DESTRUCTION / PHYSICAL STATE

### 67. reduce something to rubble — 把.....夷為廢墟

#### Practice 1

The explosion **reduced the building to rubble**.

爆炸把建築物夷為廢墟。

#### Practice 2

Several houses were reduced to rubble.

數間房屋被摧毀成一片瓦礫。

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### 68. reduce something to ashes — 把.....燒成灰燼

#### Practice 1

The fire **reduced the house to ashes**.

大火把房屋燒成灰燼。

#### Practice 2

The documents were reduced to ashes.

文件化為灰燼。

---

## 69. reduce something to dust — 把.....變成粉末／灰塵

### Practice 1

The material was **reduced to dust**.

材料被磨成粉末。

### Practice 2

Centuries of erosion reduced the surface to dust.

數百年侵蝕令表面變成粉塵。

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## O. REDUCE TO ESSENTIALS / SIMPLIFY

## 70. reduce something to its essentials — 把某事簡化至最核心部分

### Practice 1

The summary **reduces the argument to its essentials**.

摘要把論點簡化至最核心部分。

### Practice 2

Good teaching can reduce a complex idea to its essentials.

好的教學可以把複雜概念提煉至最重要部分。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce X to its essentials** = 去掉次要細節，只保留最核心內容

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## 71. reduce something to a simple formula/statement — 把複雜事物簡化成.....

### Practice 1

The theory cannot be **reduced to a simple formula**.

這個理論不能簡化成一條簡單公式。

### Practice 2

Human behaviour cannot always be reduced to one explanation.

人的行為不能總是簡化成單一解釋。

---

## 72. reduce a problem to X — 把問題歸結／簡化為 X

### Practice 1

It is misleading to **reduce the problem to poor communication alone**.

把問題簡化成只有溝通不良一個原因會產生誤導。

### Practice 2

The debate was reduced to a question of cost.

討論被簡化成純粹的成本問題。

---

## P. REDUCTIVE

## 73. reductive = oversimplifying something complex — 過分簡化的

A very useful academic extension.

### Practice 1

That explanation is too **reductive**.

那個解釋過分簡化。

### Practice 2

It would be reductive to blame the failure on one employee.

把失敗完全歸咎於一名員工會是過分簡化的看法。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reductive** = 把複雜問題簡化得過頭，以致失去重要差異或真實性

---

## 74. reductive explanation — 過度簡化的解釋

### Practice 1

“Poor leadership caused everything” is a **reductive explanation**.

「一切都是管理不善造成」是一個過度簡化的解釋。

### Practice 2

The issue needs more than a reductive account.

這個問題不能只靠過分簡化的說法解釋。

---

## 75. reductive view — 過度簡化的觀點

### Practice 1

A purely financial interpretation may be too reductive.

純粹從財務角度解讀可能過於簡化。

### Practice 2

The article rejects reductive views of teamwork.

文章反對對團隊合作作過度簡化的理解。

---

## Q. MATHEMATICS

## 76. reduce a fraction — 約分

A major mathematical sense.

### Practice 1

**Reduce the fraction** to its simplest form.

把分數約至最簡形式。

### Practice 2

Six eighths reduces to three quarters.

八分之六可以約分成四分之三。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce a fraction** = 分子和分母同除以公因數，使分數變成等值但更簡單的形式

---

## 77. reduce to lowest terms — 約至最簡分數

## Practice 1

Reduce  $12/18$  to **lowest terms**.

把  $12/18$  約至最簡形式。

## Practice 2

The fraction is already reduced to lowest terms.

這個分數已經約到最簡。

---

# 78. reduce an expression/equation — 化簡算式／方程

## Practice 1

The expression can be **reduced to a simpler form**.

這個算式可以化簡成較簡單形式。

## Practice 2

Algebraic manipulation reduces the equation.

代數運算可以把方程化簡。

---

# 79. row reduction — 行化簡

A standard linear-algebra term.

## Practice 1

Solve the system using **row reduction**.

使用行化簡解聯立方程。

## Practice 2

Gaussian elimination is a form of row reduction.

高斯消去法是一種行化簡方法。

---

# R. COOKING

## 80. reduce a liquid/sauce — 煮濃；收汁

A major culinary sense.

### Practice 1

**Reduce the sauce** over low heat.

用小火把醬汁煮濃／收汁。

### Practice 2

Let the liquid reduce by half.

讓液體煮至剩下一半。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduce a liquid** = 透過加熱蒸發水分，使液體體積減少、味道和濃度增加

---

## 81. reduce by half (cooking) — 煮至剩一半

### Practice 1

Simmer until the stock has **reduced by half**.

慢煮至高湯收乾至剩一半。

### Practice 2

The wine should reduce slightly before the cream is added.

加入忌廉前，葡萄酒應先略為收汁。

---

## 82. reduction = concentrated sauce/liquid — 濃縮汁；收汁

A culinary noun sense.

### Practice 1

The dish was served with a balsamic **reduction**.

菜式配上濃縮黑醋汁。

### Practice 2

A wine reduction adds concentrated flavour.

葡萄酒濃縮汁可以增加濃郁味道。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**a reduction** = 液體經加熱蒸發後形成的濃縮醬汁／液體

---

## S. CHEMISTRY

## 83. reduction = chemical gain of electrons / decrease in oxidation state — 還原

A major scientific sense.

### Practice 1

The reaction involves oxidation and **reduction**.

這個反應涉及氧化和還原。

## Practice 2

Reduction involves a gain of electrons in redox chemistry.

在氧化還原化學中，還原涉及獲得電子。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduction** = 化學反應中物種取得電子或氧化數降低的過程

---

# 84. reduce a chemical species — 還原某化學物種

## Practice 1

The compound was **reduced** during the reaction.

該化合物在反應中被還原。

## Practice 2

Hydrogen can reduce some metal oxides.

氫可以還原某些金屬氧化物。

---

# 85. oxidation-reduction / redox reaction — 氧化還原反應

## Practice 1

This is an **oxidation-reduction reaction**.

這是一個氧化還原反應。

## Practice 2

Redox reactions involve both oxidation and reduction.

氧化還原反應同時涉及氧化和還原。

---

## 86. reducing agent — 還原劑

A related technical compound.

### Practice 1

Hydrogen acts as a **reducing agent**.

氫作為還原劑。

### Practice 2

A reducing agent causes another species to be reduced.

還原劑令另一物種發生還原。

---

## T. COMPUTING / DATA

## 87. data reduction — 數據縮減；資料簡化

### Practice 1

The analysis begins with **data reduction**.

分析首先進行數據縮減／整理。

### Practice 2

Data reduction makes large datasets easier to analyse.

資料縮減令大型數據集更容易分析。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**data reduction** = 把大量資料轉換成較小、更有用或更易分析的形式

---

## 88. dimensionality reduction — 降維

A major machine-learning/statistics term.

### Practice 1

PCA is often used for **dimensionality reduction**.

PCA 常用於降維。

### Practice 2

Dimensionality reduction can simplify a dataset while preserving important information.

降維可以在保留重要資訊的同時簡化數據集。

---

## 89. noise reduction — 降噪；減少雜訊

### Practice 1

The headphones use active **noise reduction**.

耳機使用主動降噪技術。

### Practice 2

Noise reduction improved the recording.

降噪處理改善了錄音。

---

## 90. reduce file size — 縮小檔案

### Practice 1

Compression can **reduce file size**.

壓縮可以縮小檔案大小。

### Practice 2

Resize the image to reduce the file size.

調整圖像尺寸以減少檔案容量。

---

## U. ENGINEERING / MECHANICAL

### 91. reduce speed — 降低速度 ; 減速

#### Practice 1

Drivers should **reduce speed** near schools.

駕駛者在學校附近應減速。

#### Practice 2

The mechanism reduces motor speed.

該機制會降低馬達速度。

---

### 92. speed reduction — 減速

#### Practice 1

The gearbox provides **speed reduction**.

齒輪箱提供減速作用。

## Practice 2

Speed reduction increases torque in some mechanical systems.

某些機械系統中，減速可以增加扭矩。

---

# 93. reduction gear / reduction gearbox — 減速齒輪／減速箱

## Practice 1

The motor drives the machine through a **reduction gearbox**.

馬達透過減速箱驅動機器。

## Practice 2

Reduction gearing lowers rotational speed.

減速齒輪組會降低轉速。

---

# 94. reducer — 變徑接頭／減速器／減壓裝置

A technical noun whose meaning depends heavily on domain.

## Practice 1

A pipe **reducer** connects pipes of different diameters.

管道變徑接頭連接不同直徑的管道。

## Practice 2

The system includes a speed reducer.

系統包括一個減速器。

---

## V. MEDICAL PROCEDURE: REDUCTION

### 95. reduction of a fracture — 骨折復位

A major medical sense.

#### Practice 1

The fracture required **reduction**.

骨折需要進行復位。

#### Practice 2

Doctors performed a closed reduction.

醫生進行了閉合復位。

#### MCQ-ready definition:

**reduction** = 醫學上把移位的骨、關節或組織恢復至較正常解剖位置的程序

---

### 96. closed reduction — 閉合復位

#### Practice 1

The fracture was treated with **closed reduction**.

骨折以閉合復位處理。

#### Practice 2

Closed reduction does not require surgically opening the fracture site.

閉合復位不需要以手術切開骨折位置。

---

## 97. open reduction — 切開復位

### Practice 1

Severe fractures may require **open reduction**.

嚴重骨折可能需要切開復位。

### Practice 2

Open reduction allows direct surgical alignment.

切開復位讓醫生以手術直接把骨頭重新對正。

---

## 98. breast reduction — 縮胸手術；乳房縮小術

### Practice 1

She underwent **breast reduction surgery**.

她接受了乳房縮小手術。

### Practice 2

Breast reduction removes tissue to reduce breast size.

縮胸手術透過移除組織來縮小乳房。

---

## W. PHOTOGRAPHY / SCALE

## 99. reduction = making a copy smaller — 縮小；縮印

### Practice 1

The image is a **reduction of the original**.

這幅圖是原圖的縮小版本。

### Practice 2

The document was printed at a 50% reduction.

文件以縮小至百分之五十的比例打印。

---

## 100. reduce an image — 縮小圖像

### Practice 1

Reduce the image before inserting it.

插入前先縮小圖像。

### Practice 2

The photograph was reduced to fit the page.

照片被縮小以配合頁面。

---

## X. DISCOUNT / COMMERCIAL REDUCTION

### 101. reduction = price reduction / discount — 減價; 折扣

#### Practice 1

Members receive a 10% **reduction**.

會員可享九折／百分之十減價。

## Practice 2

There has been a substantial reduction in prices.

價格已經大幅下降。

---

# 102. price reduction — 降價

## Practice 1

The store announced a **price reduction**.

商店宣布降價。

## Practice 2

The price reduction increased demand.

降價令需求上升。

---

# 103. reduction on something — 某項收費的折扣

Especially BrE.

## Practice 1

Students may receive a **reduction on the admission fee**.

學生可能可以獲得入場費折扣。

## Practice 2

Ask whether there is a reduction for groups.

問問團體是否有優惠折扣。

---

## Y. REDUCED CIRCUMSTANCES

### 104. reduced circumstances — 經濟狀況大不如前；生活拮据

An established expression.

#### Practice 1

The family was living in **reduced circumstances**.

這個家庭的經濟狀況大不如前，生活較為拮据。

#### Practice 2

After losing the business, he found himself in reduced circumstances.

失去生意後，他發現自己經濟狀況大幅轉差。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduced circumstances** = 比以前貧困很多、經濟能力明顯下降的生活狀態

---

## Z. REDUCED = LOWER / LESS THAN NORMAL

### 105. reduced capacity — 較低能力／產能

#### Practice 1

The factory is operating at **reduced capacity**.

工廠正以較低產能運作。

## Practice 2

The service continued at reduced capacity.

服務以縮減後的規模繼續。

---

# 106. reduced visibility — 能見度降低

## Practice 1

Drivers should slow down in **reduced visibility**.

在能見度降低的情況下，駕駛者應減速。

## Practice 2

Fog caused reduced visibility.

霧氣造成低能見度。

---

# 107. reduced mobility — 行動能力下降

## Practice 1

The building has facilities for people with **reduced mobility**.

大樓設有供行動不便人士使用的設施。

## Practice 2

Injury can cause temporarily reduced mobility.

受傷可能造成暫時性的行動能力下降。

---

## 108. reduced function / functionality — 功能降低

### Practice 1

The system continued with **reduced functionality**.

系統以功能受限的模式繼續運作。

### Practice 2

The damaged organ showed reduced function.

受損器官的功能下降。

---

## AA. REDUCTION AS GENERAL NOUN

## 109. reduction = decrease — 減少; 降低; 縮減

### Practice 1

There has been a significant **reduction in confusion**.

混亂程度已有顯著減少。

### Practice 2

The company reported a reduction in costs.

公司報告成本有所降低。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reduction** = 數量、程度、規模或強度變小的過程或結果

---

## 110. reduction in something — 某事物的下降

### Practice 1

We saw a **reduction in errors**.

我們看到錯誤有所減少。

### Practice 2

There was a sharp reduction in demand.

需求出現大幅下降。

---

## 111. reduction of something — 對某事物的削減／減少

### Practice 1

The **reduction of waste** is a major objective.

減少廢物是一項主要目標。

### Practice 2

The plan calls for the reduction of unnecessary costs.

計劃要求削減不必要成本。

---

## 112. significant / substantial reduction — 顯著／大幅減少

### Practice 1

There was a **substantial reduction in processing time**.

處理時間大幅縮短。

### Practice 2

The programme produced a significant reduction in errors.

計劃令錯誤數量顯著減少。

---

## 113. percentage reduction — 百分比減幅

### Practice 1

The table shows the **percentage reduction in costs**.

表格顯示成本的百分比減幅。

### Practice 2

Calculate the percentage reduction.

計算百分比減幅。

---

## 114. reduction target — 削減目標

### Practice 1

The company set an emissions **reduction target**.

公司設定了減排目標。

## Practice 2

The cost-reduction target was achieved.

成本削減目標已經達成。

---

# AB. REDUCIBLE / IRREDUCIBLE

## 115. reducible = capable of being reduced — 可減少／可化簡的

### Practice 1

Some costs are more easily **reducible** than others.

某些成本比其他成本更容易削減。

### Practice 2

The fraction is reducible.

這個分數可以約分。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reducible** = 可以被減少、簡化或化約的

---

## 116. irreducible = cannot be reduced further — 不能再減少／不可再化簡的

### Practice 1

Some level of uncertainty is **irreducible**.

某種程度的不確定性是無法完全消除的。

## Practice 2

The fraction is irreducible.

這個分數是不可再約分的。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**irreducible** = 不能再縮小、消除、分解或化簡的

---

# 117. irreducible minimum — 不可再降低的最低限度

## Practice 1

There is an **irreducible minimum of risk**.

存在一個無法再降低的最低風險水平。

## Practice 2

Even an efficient system has an irreducible minimum of administrative work.

即使高效系統也有某些無法再削減的最低行政工作量。

---

# 118. irreducible complexity / difference — 不可簡化的複雜性／根本差異

## Practice 1

Some disagreements reflect **irreducible differences in priorities**.

有些分歧反映了無法化解成同一立場的根本優先次序差異。

## Practice 2

The issue contains irreducible complexity.

這個問題存在不能進一步簡化的複雜性。

---

## AC. REDUCTIONISM

### 119. reductionism = explaining complex things entirely through simpler parts — 還原論

A major academic/philosophical/scientific extension.

#### Practice 1

Critics accused the theory of **reductionism**.

批評者指該理論過於還原論式。

#### Practice 2

Reductionism attempts to explain complex phenomena in terms of simpler components.

還原論嘗試以較簡單的組成部分解釋複雜現象。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**reductionism** = 認為複雜現象可以主要或完全透過較基本組成部分來解釋的分析立場

---

### 120. reductionist — 還原論的; 還原論者

#### Practice 1

That is a **reductionist explanation** of human behaviour.

那是對人類行為的一種還原論式解釋。

## Practice 2

A reductionist may focus on simpler underlying mechanisms.

還原論者可能集中研究較基本的底層機制。

---

# 121. reductive vs reductionist

Important distinction:

## reductive

usually critical:

oversimplifies.

## reductionist

describes a theoretical method/position:

explains wholes through parts.

A reductionist account is **not automatically bad**, although critics may call it reductive.

---

# Important distinction 1: reduce vs decrease

## reduce

normally transitive:

reduce costs  
降低成本

Something/someone **causes** the decrease.

## decrease

can be transitive or intransitive:

demand decreased  
需求下降

we decreased spending  
我們減少開支

So:

Costs were reduced.  
成本被削減。

Costs decreased.  
成本下降。

---

## Important distinction 2: reduce vs decline

From your earlier word.

### **reduce**

someone/something causes the decrease:

The new process reduced errors.

### **decline**

the thing itself becomes lower:

Errors declined.

So:

reduce = causal/transitive  
decline = often intransitive trend

---

## Important distinction 3: reduce vs lower

## **lower**

very natural with levels, prices, temperature, voice, etc.

## **reduce**

broader, especially with quantities and problems.

lower the price

降低價格

reduce waste

減少廢物

Both can work with many nouns.

---

# **Important distinction 4: reduce vs cut**

## **cut**

often stronger, more direct, more conversational.

## **reduce**

neutral/formal.

cut costs

削減成本

reduce costs

降低成本

**Cut** often suggests deliberate management action.

---

# **Important distinction 5: reduce vs lessen**

## **lessen**

especially reduce degree/intensity.

## **reduce**

much broader.

lessen anxiety  
減輕焦慮

reduce anxiety  
降低焦慮

But:

reduce the workforce   
lessen the workforce  usually unnatural

---

# **Important distinction 6: reduce vs diminish**

## **diminish**

become/make less important, strong or large; more formal.

## **reduce**

more neutral and measurable.

diminish someone's authority  
削弱某人的權威

reduce costs  
降低成本

---

# **Important distinction 7: reduce vs minimize**

## **reduce**

make less.

## **minimize**

make as small as reasonably possible.

reduce risk

降低風險

minimize risk

把風險降到最低

**Minimize** is stronger.

---

# **Important distinction 8: reduce vs eliminate**

## **reduce**

make less; some remains.

## **eliminate**

remove completely.

reduce confusion

減少混亂

eliminate confusion

完全消除混亂

Your passage deliberately says **reduce**, not **eliminate**—structured communication helps, but may not remove all confusion.

---

# **Important distinction 9: reduce vs prevent**

## **prevent**

stop something from occurring.

## **reduce**

lower its amount/frequency/impact.

prevent mistakes  
防止錯誤發生

reduce mistakes  
減少錯誤數量

This distinction is central to the passage's logic.

---

# **Important distinction 10: reduce vs relieve**

## **relieve**

ease discomfort, pressure or suffering.

## **reduce**

lower amount/degree.

relieve stress  
舒緩壓力

reduce stress  
降低壓力程度

They overlap with symptoms/emotional burden.

---

# **Important distinction 11: reduce vs shrink**

## **shrink**

become/make physically smaller, or decline in size.

## **reduce**

broader and more formal.

shirt shrank

恤衫縮水

reduce file size

縮小檔案

---

# **Important distinction 12: reduce vs shorten**

## **shorten**

specifically make shorter in:

- length,
- duration.

## **reduce**

can cover duration but is broader.

shorten the meeting

縮短會議

reduce the meeting length

減少會議長度

---

# **Important distinction 13: reduce by vs reduce to**

Extremely important.

**reduce by 20%**

下降了百分之二十.

**reduce to 20%**

下降至百分之二十.

These are completely different numbers.

---

## **Important distinction 14: reduce from A to B**

This explicitly gives:

- starting value,
- final value.

reduced from 100 to 80

= 由 **100** 減至 **80**

Therefore reduction amount = 20.

---

## **Important distinction 15: reduction in vs reduction of**

**a reduction in X**

emphasizes that X decreased:

a reduction in errors  
錯誤數量下降

**the reduction of X**

emphasizes the action/process of reducing X:

the reduction of waste  
減少廢物這件事

Both can overlap.

---

## Important distinction 16: reduce someone to tears

This does not mean:

make the number of tears smaller.

It means:

**bring someone into the emotional state of crying**

This belongs to the:

**reduce X to Y = 使 X 淪為／陷入 Y 狀態**

branch.

---

## Important distinction 17: be reduced to doing something

Usually carries a negative nuance:

fewer alternatives remain until someone can only do X.

reduced to guessing  
只能靠猜

reduced to begging  
淪落到乞討

It often implies loss of status, options or control.

---

## **Important distinction 18: reduce to rubble vs destroy**

### **destroy**

general destruction.

### **reduce to rubble**

emphasizes the resulting state:

building → rubble.

The **to** phrase names the final state.

---

## **Important distinction 19: reduce to essentials vs summarize**

### **summarize**

state the main points briefly.

### **reduce to essentials**

strip away secondary elements until only the essential structure remains.

The second can sound more analytical or abstract.

---

## Important distinction 20: reduce vs simplify

### **simplify**

make easier to understand/use.

### **reduce**

make less/smaller, or sometimes strip something down.

A simplified system is not necessarily smaller.

A reduced system may be smaller without being easier.

---

## Important distinction 21: reductive vs simple

### **simple explanation**

may be excellent and clear.

### **reductive explanation**

is **too simple**, losing important complexity.

So **reductive** is usually critical.

---

## Important distinction 22: reduced price vs cheap

**reduced price**

price has been lowered from a previous/normal level.

### **cheap**

absolute judgment that price is low.

A \$5,000 item reduced from \$6,000 has a **reduced price**, but may not be cheap.

---

## **Important distinction 23: reduced rate vs discount**

### **reduced rate**

lower official charge/fee.

### **discount**

amount/percentage taken off a normal price.

student reduced rate  
學生優惠收費

20% discount  
八折／減百分之二十

---

## **Important distinction 24: reduce a sauce**

This does not mean:

make the sauce “less important.”

It means:

**evaporate water so the volume falls and concentration increases**

Interestingly:

quantity decreases  
while  
flavour concentration increases.

---

## Important distinction 25: chemical reduction vs ordinary reduction

Ordinary:

reduce temperature  
降低溫度

Chemistry:

reduction = electron gain / lower oxidation state  
還原

It does **not** simply mean “there is less chemical”.

---

## Important distinction 26: reduce a fraction

This does not change its mathematical value.

Example:

$$6/8 \rightarrow 3/4$$

The notation becomes simpler, but the quantity remains equal.

So Chinese is naturally:

約分

rather than 「減少」.

---

## Important distinction 27: reduction in medicine

In:

fracture reduction

**reduction** means:

**putting displaced anatomy back into a more normal position**

It does not mean making the fracture smaller.

---

## Important distinction 28: reduced circumstances

This is a fixed expression.

It does not merely mean:

“fewer circumstances.”

It means:

**a significant decline in someone's financial/social material situation**

Natural Chinese:

家道中落／經濟拮据／財力大不如前

depending on context.

---

## Important distinction 29: reduced mobility

This normally means:

**limited ability to move around**

not:

somebody deliberately reduced the amount of movement.

---

## **Important distinction 30: reducible vs reduced**

**reducible**

can be reduced.

**reduced**

has already been reduced.

reducible fraction  
可約分的分數

reduced fraction  
已約分的分數

---

## **Important distinction 31: irreducible vs impossible to eliminate**

**Irreducible** can mean:

**cannot be reduced further**

but context decides whether that means:

- size,
- complexity,
- mathematical form,
- risk,

- conceptual structure.

irreducible risk  
無法再降低的風險

irreducible fraction  
不可約分數

---

## Important distinction 32: reductionism vs reductive

### reductionism

theory/method.

### reductive

judgment that something oversimplifies.

Therefore:

reductionist analysis  
還原論分析

can be neutral.

reductive analysis  
過度簡化的分析

is usually negative.

---

## Important distinction 33: reduce vs compress

compress

pack data/material into less space.

## **reduce**

broader result of making smaller.

Compression often reduces:

- file size,
- volume.

But reduction does not necessarily involve compression.

---

# **Important distinction 34: reduce vs dilute**

## **dilute**

make a liquid/substance weaker by adding solvent.

## **reduce a sauce**

does the opposite in concentration:  
water evaporates → sauce becomes stronger.

Excellent contrast:

dilute sauce = make less concentrated

reduce sauce = make more concentrated by decreasing liquid volume

---

# **Important distinction 35: reduce in your passage**

The phrase is:

**reduce confusion substantially**

Three things matter:

## **reduce**

not eliminate—confusion becomes smaller.

## **confusion**

an abstract degree/state, not a countable physical quantity.

## **substantially**

the decrease is large and meaningful.

So the sentence means:

**structured communication can make uncertainty and misunderstanding considerably less severe**

---

# **Family-extension note**

The **reduce** family has one central idea:

**make something smaller, less, lower, simpler, or bring it into a lower/more basic state**

That branches widely:

### **1. general quantity**

- reduce number
- reduce amount

### **2. intensity**

- reduce stress
- reduce confusion

### **3. risk/harm**

- reduce risk
- harm reduction

#### **4. money**

- reduce costs
- reduce debt

#### **5. price/rates**

- reduced price
- reduced fare

#### **6. demand/supply**

- reduce demand
- reduce consumption

#### **7. environment**

- reduce waste
- reduce emissions

#### **8. scale/workforce**

- reduce staff
- reduced hours

#### **9. social problems**

- reduce poverty
- reduce inequality

#### **10. health**

- reduce pain
- reduce blood pressure

#### **11. measurement grammar**

- reduce by
- reduce to
- reduce from A to B

#### **12. bring into a state**

- reduce to tears

- reduce to rubble
- be reduced to guessing

### **13. simplification**

- reduce to essentials

### **14. critically oversimplify**

- reductive

### **15. mathematics**

- reduce a fraction
- row reduction

### **16. cooking**

- reduce a sauce
- reduction

### **17. chemistry**

- reduction
- reducing agent

### **18. data/computing**

- data reduction
- dimensionality reduction
- noise reduction

### **19. engineering**

- speed reduction
- reduction gear

### **20. medicine**

- fracture reduction
- breast reduction

### **21. commercial**

- price reduction
- reduced rate

## 22. fixed adjective expressions

- reduced circumstances
- reduced mobility

## 23. abstract derivatives

- reducible
- irreducible

## 24. academic/philosophical

- reductionism
- reductionist

For your passage, the exact branch is:

**reduce = make the degree of confusion significantly lower**

---

# Master comparison

| Form / expression        | Traditional Chinese | Core idea       |
|--------------------------|---------------------|-----------------|
| <b>reduce</b>            | 減少; 降低              | make less       |
| <b>reduce confusion</b>  | 減少混亂                | lower confusion |
| <b>reduce mistakes</b>   | 減少錯誤                | fewer mistakes  |
| <b>reduce the amount</b> | 減少數量                | quantity        |
| <b>reduce the number</b> | 減少數目                | count           |
| <b>reduce the level</b>  | 降低水平                | degree          |
| <b>reduce the rate</b>   | 降低比率                | rate            |
| <b>reduce size</b>       | 縮小                  | size            |

|                            |         |                        |
|----------------------------|---------|------------------------|
| <b>reduce waiting time</b> | 縮短等候時間  | duration               |
| <b>reduce stress</b>       | 減輕壓力    | intensity              |
| <b>reduce pressure</b>     | 減輕／降低壓力 | intensity              |
| <b>reduce pain</b>         | 減輕疼痛    | symptom                |
| <b>reduce tension</b>      | 緩和緊張    | tension                |
| <b>reduce uncertainty</b>  | 減少不確定性  | uncertainty            |
| <b>reduce risk</b>         | 降低風險    | risk                   |
| <b>risk reduction</b>      | 風險降低    | risk management        |
| <b>harm reduction</b>      | 減害      | reduce<br>consequences |
| <b>reduce costs</b>        | 降低成本    | money                  |
| <b>reduce spending</b>     | 減少開支    | expenditure            |
| <b>reduce budget</b>       | 削減預算    | budget                 |
| <b>reduce debt</b>         | 減債      | debt                   |
| <b>cost reduction</b>      | 成本削減    | cost control           |
| <b>reduce price</b>        | 降價      | price                  |
| <b>reduced price</b>       | 減價／優惠價  | lower price            |
| <b>reduced rate</b>        | 優惠費率    | lower rate             |
| <b>reduced fare</b>        | 優惠票價    | transport              |
| <b>reduce demand</b>       | 降低需求    | demand                 |
| <b>reduce supply</b>       | 減少供應    | supply                 |
| <b>reduce consumption</b>  | 減少消耗    | consumption            |
| <b>reduce waste</b>        | 減少廢物    | environment            |

|                              |             |                  |
|------------------------------|-------------|------------------|
| <b>waste reduction</b>       | 減廢          | environment      |
| <b>reduce pollution</b>      | 減少污染        | environment      |
| <b>reduce emissions</b>      | 減排          | environment      |
| <b>reduce workforce</b>      | 減少人手        | staffing         |
| <b>reduced hours</b>         | 縮短工時        | work             |
| <b>reduce inequality</b>     | 減少不平等       | society          |
| <b>reduce poverty</b>        | 減貧          | society          |
| <b>reduce unemployment</b>   | 降低失業        | economy          |
| <b>reduce crime</b>          | 減少罪案        | society          |
| <b>reduce blood pressure</b> | 降低血壓        | medical          |
| <b>reduce swelling</b>       | 減輕腫脹        | medical          |
| <b>reduce symptoms</b>       | 減輕症狀        | medical          |
| <b>reduce by X</b>           | 減少了 X       | amount of change |
| <b>reduce to X</b>           | 減至 X        | final level      |
| <b>reduce from A to B</b>    | 由 A 減至 B    | start/end        |
| <b>reduce by half</b>        | 減少一半        | change amount    |
| <b>reduce substantially</b>  | 大幅減少        | degree           |
| <b>reduce significantly</b>  | 顯著降低        | degree           |
| <b>reduce X to Y</b>         | 使 X 變成／陷入 Y | resulting state  |
| <b>reduce to tears</b>       | 令某人哭起來      | emotional state  |
| <b>reduce to silence</b>     | 令某人無言       | state            |
| <b>be reduced to doing</b>   | 淪落／只能做      | loss of options  |

|                                 |           |                    |
|---------------------------------|-----------|--------------------|
| <b>reduce to rubble</b>         | 夷為廢墟      | destruction        |
| <b>reduce to ashes</b>          | 化為灰燼      | destruction        |
| <b>reduce to essentials</b>     | 簡化至核心     | simplification     |
| <b>reductive</b>                | 過分簡化的     | oversimplification |
| <b>reduce a fraction</b>        | 約分        | mathematics        |
| <b>reduce to lowest terms</b>   | 約至最簡      | mathematics        |
| <b>row reduction</b>            | 行化簡       | mathematics        |
| <b>reduce a sauce</b>           | 收汁; 煮濃    | cooking            |
| <b>a reduction</b> (sauce)      | 濃縮汁       | cooking            |
| <b>reduction</b> (chemistry)    | 還原        | chemistry          |
| <b>reducing agent</b>           | 還原劑       | chemistry          |
| <b>data reduction</b>           | 數據縮減      | computing          |
| <b>dimensionality reduction</b> | 降維        | data science       |
| <b>noise reduction</b>          | 降噪        | signal/audio       |
| <b>reduce file size</b>         | 縮小檔案      | computing          |
| <b>speed reduction</b>          | 減速        | engineering        |
| <b>reduction gear</b>           | 減速齒輪      | engineering        |
| <b>reducer</b>                  | 減速器／變徑接頭等 | technical          |
| <b>fracture reduction</b>       | 骨折復位      | medicine           |
| <b>closed reduction</b>         | 閉合復位      | medicine           |
| <b>open reduction</b>           | 切開復位      | medicine           |
| <b>breast reduction</b>         | 縮胸手術      | medicine           |

|                              |            |                      |
|------------------------------|------------|----------------------|
| <b>price reduction</b>       | 降價         | commercial           |
| <b>reduced circumstances</b> | 經濟狀況大不如前   | fixed expression     |
| <b>reduced capacity</b>      | 較低產能／容量    | lower capacity       |
| <b>reduced visibility</b>    | 能見度降低      | visibility           |
| <b>reduced mobility</b>      | 行動能力下降     | mobility             |
| <b>reduction in X</b>        | X 的下降      | noun result          |
| <b>reduction of X</b>        | 對 X 的削減    | noun process         |
| <b>reduction target</b>      | 削減目標       | target               |
| <b>reducible</b>             | 可減少／可化簡的   | can be reduced       |
| <b>irreducible</b>           | 不可再減少／化簡的  | cannot be reduced    |
| <b>irreducible minimum</b>   | 不可再降低的最低限度 | minimum              |
| <b>reductionism</b>          | 還原論        | theoretical approach |
| <b>reductionist</b>          | 還原論的／還原論者  | theory/person        |

## For your original sentence

Brief but regular meetings, written summaries and digital project-management tools can **reduce confusion substantially**.

Here:

**reduce confusion substantially** = 透過更清楚、更有結構的資訊交換，令員工之間的誤解、不確定性和不知道該做甚麼的情況大幅下降

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

簡短但定期的會議、書面摘要以及數碼項目管理工具，都可以大幅減少混亂。

The cleanest contrast is:

**prevent confusion** = 防止混亂發生

**reduce confusion** = 混亂仍可能存在, 但程度明顯降低

**minimise confusion** = 把混亂盡量降到最低

**eliminate confusion** = 完全消除混亂

**clarify** = 把某件事解釋／界定得更清楚

And one very important structural contrast is:

**confusion declined** = 混亂程度自己下降

**the tools reduced confusion** = 這些工具造成了混亂程度下降

So in your passage, **reduce** expresses a clear **cause** → **lower degree** relationship.